COST ESTIMATE · POST-LAUNCH

Estimated Monthly Running Costs

GetReady – what it costs to keep the platform live

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Currency Shown in USD and INR at an assumed ₹95 per US$ (the rate moves; actual bills follow the day's rate)

1. Purpose

The development quotation covers building the platform. Once it is live, the client also pays third-party providers for hosting, SMS, storage and app-store accounts. These are billed directly to the client's own accounts and are separate from our development fees and from the post-launch maintenance fee, which is still to be agreed. This page gives realistic monthly figures so there are no surprises.

2. Estimated Total per Month

Setup	What it means	Cloud / month	Total / month (₹)
Lean launch (recommended to start)	One small server or serverless container with a small managed database. Suits the first few hundred to a few thousand users.	US$ 40–70 (₹3,800–6,650)	≈ ₹6,000–10,500
Standard production	Two app instances, a high-availability database and a proper load balancer. For when uptime matters more than cost.	US$ 150–230 (₹14,250–21,850)	≈ ₹16,000–26,000

Totals include cloud hosting plus SMS/OTP and other services (about ₹2,000–4,000 per month at launch volume). 18% GST is added to cloud and SMS bills in India.

3. Cloud Hosting by Growth Stage

Mumbai region, on-demand prices, per month. AWS and GCP land in a similar range; GCP Cloud Run needs less day-to-day server management, while AWS has a cheaper smallest database.

Stage	AWS (ap-south-1)	GCP (asia-south1)
MVP, up to ~500 users	US$ 30–40 (₹2,900–3,800)	US$ 60–75 (₹5,700–7,100); under US$ 25 if it scales to zero
Proper launch, a few thousand users	US$ 150–180 (₹14,250–17,100)	US$ 130–230 (₹12,350–21,850)
Growth, 20–50K users	US$ 500–800 (₹47,500–76,000)	US$ 450–750 (₹42,800–71,300)

A single VM running the existing Docker setup (including a small database) is the cheapest path: about US$ 12–25 (₹1,100–2,400) per month, with less resilience.

4. Other Services

Service	Used for	Estimated cost
SMS / OTP (Fast2SMS)	Login OTPs and SMS notifications	About ₹0.15–0.20 per SMS. 10,000 OTPs ≈ ₹1,500–2,000 per month. This is usually the largest non-cloud cost.
Image storage (Cloudinary)	Artist portfolio photos	Free up to 25 GB storage and bandwidth. About US$ 89 per month (₹8,450) on the next paid plan once outgrown.
Push notifications (Expo)	In-app push alerts	Free. Expo build service is free at launch volume.
Error tracking (Sentry)	Crash and error visibility	Free tier (5,000 errors per month).
Payments (Razorpay), Phase 2	Online payments and deposits	About 2% per transaction, no fixed fee.

5. One-Time and Yearly Costs

Item	Cost	When
Google Play developer account	US$ 25 (≈ ₹2,400)	One time
Apple Developer Program (iOS)	US$ 99 (≈ ₹9,400)	Every year, only if iOS ships
Domain name (.in / .com)	₹800–1,300	Every year

6. What Drives the Bill Up

- **OTP volume:** every sign-in and notification SMS is billed per message.
- **Image bandwidth:** portfolio photos are the product, so viewing traffic grows storage and delivery costs.
- **Video (Phase 2):** storage and streaming are expensive, which is why duration and resolution caps are agreed at Phase 2 kick-off.
- **Uptime choices:** a high-availability database and a second app instance roughly triple the cloud bill.

7. Notes & Assumptions

- These are planning estimates based on published list prices and typical early usage, not quotes. Real bills depend on traffic and the provider’s prices at the time.
- We recommend setting budget alerts on every account from day one.
- Not included: development fees (see the quotation), the post-launch maintenance fee (to be agreed), and GST on our own fees.
- Accounts (cloud, SMS, Cloudinary, app stores) are opened in the client’s name so that ownership and billing stay with the client.